

PRESENT SIMPLE

- used to talk about permanent facts and daily actions;
- used with the adverbs ***normally, usually, always, often, sometimes, rarely, never...***
e.g. She **works** in Aveiro.

Affirmative		Negative		Interrogative		
I		I		Do	I	
You		You	don't	Don't	you	
We	work.	We	work.		we	work?
They		They			they	
He		He	doesn't	Does	he	
She	works.	She	work.	Doesn't	she	work?
It		It			it	

You use the Present Simple to talk about routine actions and habits.

- I go to work by bus.*
- He works late on Tuesdays.*

You also use it to talk about ongoing situations you see as stable.

- We live in London.*
- They employ over 250 people.*

NEGATIVE – don't/doesn't + infinitive e.g. - She doesn't work here.

INTERROGATIVE – do/does + infinitive e.g. - Does she work here?

Exception: verb "to be" / "have got"

Jane introduces Claude to João in London. Complete the dialogue by putting each of the verbs in brackets into the correct form of the present simple.

- JANE: Claude, (1) Do you know (you / know) João? João (2) (be) from Brazil, but he worked with me in Paris last year. He (3) (know) a lot about your line of work.
- CLAUDE: Really! Well I (4) (be) very pleased to meet you, João.
- JOÃO: Pleased to meet you too, Claude.
- CLAUDE: So, what exactly (5) (you / do)?
- JOÃO: I (6) (work) in the oil industry as a market analyst.
- CLAUDE: Oh, so you (7) (make) decisions about levels of production?
- JOÃO: No, I (8) (not make) any decisions really. My job (9) (involve) studying market trends and giving advice on levels of production.
- CLAUDE: Still, that's a lot of responsibility.
- JOÃO: Well, yes, but Brazil (10) (not / be) a major producer like Saudi Arabia. What about you?
- CLAUDE: I work for a French company that (11) (supply) specialised equipment to the oil industry. We (12) (be) one of the biggest companies in our market.
- JOÃO: Oh, really? And (13) (you / often / come) to London?
- CLAUDE: Yes, quite often. My company (14) (have) an office here. It (15) (not / take) long to get here now, if you travel by Eurostar. Could I give you my card?

PRESENT CONTINUOUS

(v. *To Be* in the S. Present + *-ing* form)

- used to talk about temporary actions that are happening now or that may be acurrent trend;
- used with the adverbs **at the moment, now...**
e.g. She **is helping** me.

*** Some verbs are not usually used in the present continuous, e.g. believe, can, feel, know, like, love, need, prefer, understand, want, wish.**

Affirmative		Negative		Interrogative		
I'm (am)	working.	I'm not	working.	Am Aren't	I	working?
You're (are)		You aren't		Are Aren't	you	
We're (are)		We aren't			we	
They're (are)		They aren't		Is Aren't	they	
He's (is)		He isn't			he	
She's (is)		She isn't			she	
It's (is)		It isn't			it	

Complete the sentences. Put in the present continuous or in the simple present.

Mark: ► **Are you looking** (you / look) for someone?

Alan: Yes, *I need* (I / need) to speak to Neil. He isn't in his office.

Mark: (1) (he / talk) to the boss at
the moment. (2) (I/ think) (3)
..... (they/discuss) money.

Alan: Oh, right. And what about you? (4) (You / look) for
someone too?

Mark: Yes, Linda. (5) (you / know) where she is?

Alan: Oh, she isn't here today. She only (6) (work) four days a week.
(7) (she / not / work) on Fridays. She'll be here on Monday.

Mark: Thank you. (8) (you / know) a lot about Linda.

Alan: Well, most days (9) (I / give) her a lift, or (10)
(she / give)
me one. (11) (she / live) quite close to me. (12)
.....
(it/save) petrol.

Mark: Yes, of course. Good idea. Yes, (13) (I / agree).

SIMPLE PAST

- used to talk about **finished actions** in the past;
- used with **yesterday, last day/week/month/year...**

e.g. She **worked** at the hotel.

Regular verbs: + -ed	start → started	live → lived
Irregular verbs: (see list)	go → went	have → had

Affirmative		Negative		Interrogative	
I		I		I	
You		You		you	
He		He		he	
She	worked.	She	didn't work.	Did	work?
It		It		Didn't	
We		We		it	
They		They		we	
				they	

NEGATIVE – didn't + infinitive e.g. - She **didn't go** to Lisbon.

INTERROGATIVE – did + infinitive e.g. - Did **she go** to Lisbon?

Exception: verb "to be"/

PAST CONTINUOUS

(v. *To Be* in the S. Past + *-ing* form)

e.g. She **was helping** me.

Underline the best continuation of the conversations.

1 A: What was she doing this morning?

B: She interviewed / was interviewing candidates for the sales job.

2 A: How did Brenda spend her holiday?

B: Most days she went / was going to the beach.

3 A: What happened after you launched the product?

B: While we promoted / were promoting it, our main competitor dropped / was dropping their prices.

4 A: I didn't see you in the office last week.

B: No, I worked / was working at home for a few days.

5 A: What did Pat do when she saw the artwork?

B: She called / was calling the designers and said / was saying it wasn't suitable.

6 A: Why did Renata take so long to get here?

B: She said they mended / were mending the road and so the traffic moved / was moving very slowly.

Complete the sentences by putting the verbs in brackets into either the past simple or past continuous. Sometimes the same tense is used twice; sometimes different tenses are used.

- 1 What did you eat (eat) when you went (go) to Paris?
- 2 While I was negotiating (negotiate) the contract, my boss phoned (phone) me to say that he wanted completely different conditions.
- 3 The last time something like this (happen), she (call) a press conference immediately.
- 4 Anne (explain) her proposal when Pedro (interrupt) her.
- 5 We never got the chance to interview him. While we (investigate) the incident, he (resign).
- 6 When he (finish) reading the article, he (give) it to me.
- 7 Everyone (wait) for the meeting to begin when he (call) to say that he was stuck in a traffic jam.
- 8 When I (clean) the piece I (drop) it by mistake.
- 9 I (find) the missing file while I (look) for some other documents.
- 10 When Tim (arrive), we (tell) him what had happened.

PRESENT PERFECT (v. *To Have* in the S. Present + Past Participle)

- ☐ She **has talked** to several experts in order to solve the problem.
- ☐ I **'ve seen** a lot of changes around here.

- * **used to talk about unspecified time before the present;**
- * **used to talk about a series of actions that happened in our life up to now.**
- * **used with *yet, just, already, since,***

Affirmative

I You We They	've (have)	finished the report.
He She	's has	

Negative

I You We They	haven't	finished the report.
He She	hasn't	

Interrogative

Have Haven't	I you we they	finished the report?
Has Hasn't	he she	

Complete the sentences by putting the verbs in brackets into a form of the present perfect. Use contractions where possible.

- 1 Are you sure it isn't working? Have you tried (you/try) it?
- 2 I (never/see) such a boring presentation.
- 3 Luckily, our customers (not/complain) about the price rise.
- 4 We (already/spend) quite a lot of money on this project.
- 5 (they/reply) to your last email?
- 6 I (not/get) the figures to hand – can I call you back later?
- 7 Unemployment (go/up) by 2% since January.
- 8 I'm sorry, she's not here. She (just/leave).
- 9 Their shares (fall) by 15% since the merger.
- 10 (you/ever/take) the Eurostar to Brussels?

Complete this dialogue by putting the verbs in brackets into the correct form of the past simple or present perfect. Use contractions where possible.

- VICTORIA: Hi, Sue. I (1) haven't seen (not/see) you for ages!
- SUE: Hi. No, I'm sorry. I (2) (not/be) in touch with anyone recently ... I (3) (be) really busy.
- VICTORIA: Oh, what have you been up to then?
- SUE: Well, you know I (4) (leave) my job in January so that I (5) (can) go freelance as a graphic designer?
- VICTORIA: Yes, I remember, you (6) (talk) a lot about that last year. How's it going?
- SUE: Well, it (7) (be) a really difficult year so far. I (8) (never/do) anything like this before ... it's much harder work than I (9) (imagine). (10) (you/ever/be) self-employed?
- VICTORIA: No, never, although I (11) (often/think) about it. So, why has it been so difficult?
- SUE: Well, at the beginning I (12) (have) two or three good clients – and, you know, people that I (13) (know) for many years, like Tom Pierce. And since then I (14) (have) a lot of interest from different companies, but none of them (15) (become) regular customers.
- VICTORIA: What about advertising in the specialist magazines?
- SUE: I (16) (already/do) that. I (17) (put) an advert in Design Monthly a couple of months ago, but I (18) (not/get) any replies.
- VICTORIA: Oh, dear, well, (19) (put) up a website with examples of your work?
- SUE: Yes, I (20) (just/finish) it. Would you mind having a quick look at it and tell me what you think of it?

Bibliography:

EMMERSON, Paul (2002), *Business Grammar Builder – For class and self study*. Oxford: Macmillan